

76 Wishes and regrets

English uses the verb “wish” to talk about present and past regrets. The tense of the verb that follows “wish” affects the meaning of the sentence.

⚙️ **New language** “Wish” with past tenses

Aa **Vocabulary** Life events

🧩 **New skill** Talking about regrets

76.1 KEY LANGUAGE “WISH” AND PAST SIMPLE

Use “wish” with the past simple, or with the modal verbs “would” and “could,” to express regrets and desires about the present.

I **wish** I **earned** more money.

Use the past simple to talk about the present.



This music is horrible! I **wish** it **would** stop.

You can also use modal verbs to express wishes about the present.



76.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES “WISH” AND PAST SIMPLE

He **wishes** he **could** afford a big house.



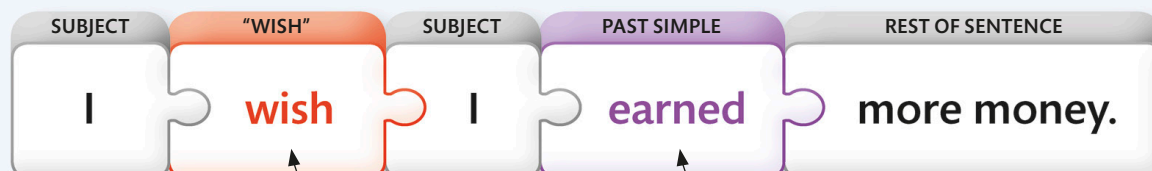
I **wish** you **didn't have to** work so hard.



They **wish** the weather **was** better.



76.3 HOW TO FORM “WISH” AND PAST SIMPLE



Use “wish” or “wishes” depending on the subject.

The past simple expresses wishes or regrets about the present.